

10 rods, so the abacus ring was a variation of sorts.

The Victorian ingenuity of the air conditioned top hat in the 1800s

The Victorian era is generally associated with vanity. Historians may or may not agree with that view. However, if you go by the fact that they came up with an airconditioned top hat to minimize the sweat on the scalp of many a high-browed gentleman, you would side with the 'vanity-view.' The invention remained in fashion for just the briefest of times.



Some gentlemen apparently didn't think much of the "sweat of your brow" idea

'Electric Girl Lighting Company' introducing dresses fitted with bulbs and batteries to light up houses in the 1890s

The company in question was started in 1884 in America when the concept of electricity was, well..electrifying the entire nation. The correlation between the human body and electricity was taken from its conceptual cradle to materialistic reality by the company which aimed to give dresses that were fitted with batteries and bulbs that can be worn by women. This would help light up the home. In other words, a wife being the light of the house was an idea that the company took to heart. As shown by subsequent history, the people of America, or the rest of the world didn't find this an electrifying idea.

The pigeon camera in 1907

Pigeons may be the emissaries of love as far as Bollywood is concerned but the German photographer, Julius Neubronner had a different idea. Neubronner-who lived more than a century ago used to be an apothecary whose job entailed the use of carrier pigeons to deliver medications to clients. However, when one of his pigeons returned four weeks later than expected, Neubronner hit upon the idea of mounting a lightweight camera